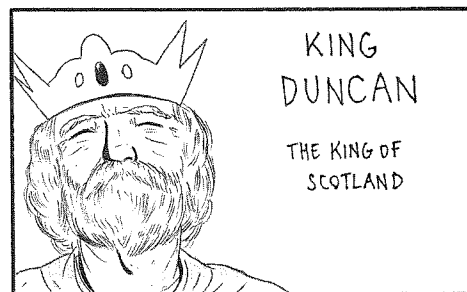
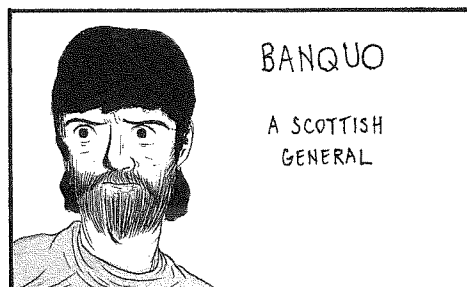
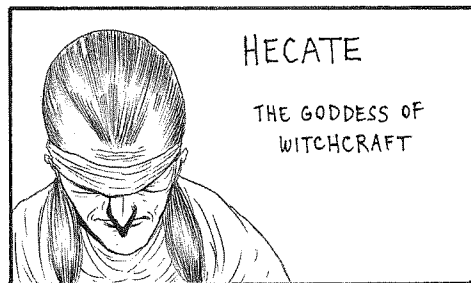
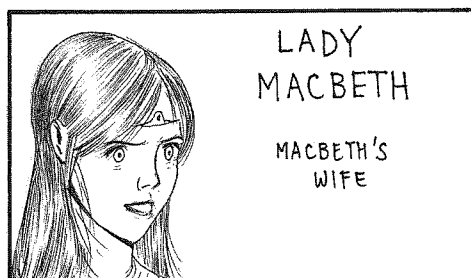
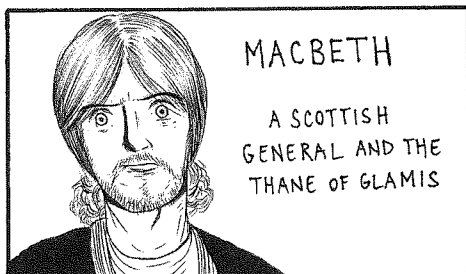
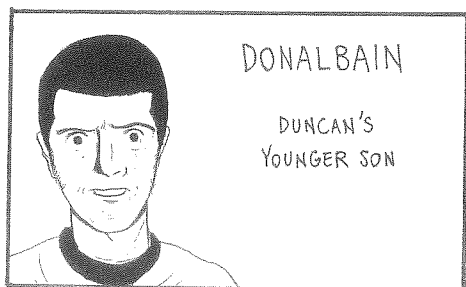


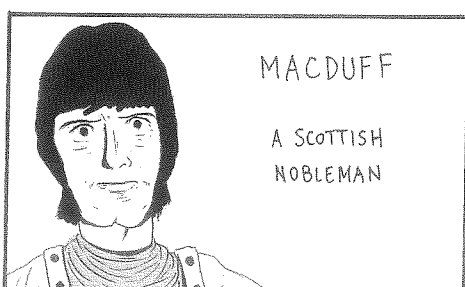
· CHARACTERS ·





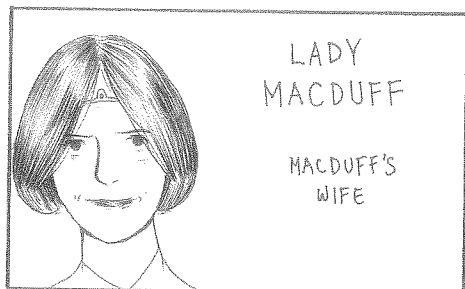
DONALBAIN

DUNCAN'S
YOUNGER SON



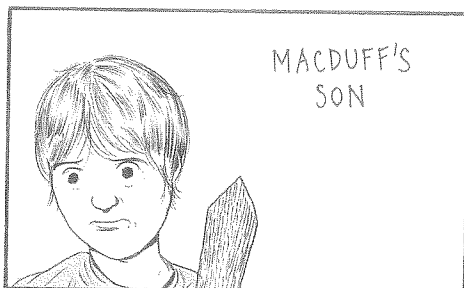
MACDUFF

A SCOTTISH
NOBLEMAN

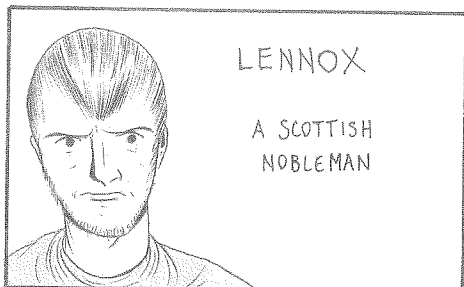


LADY
MACDUFF

MACDUFF'S
WIFE

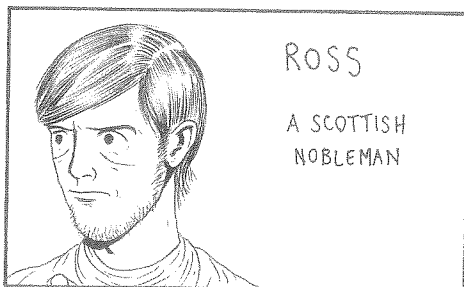


MACDUFF'S
SON



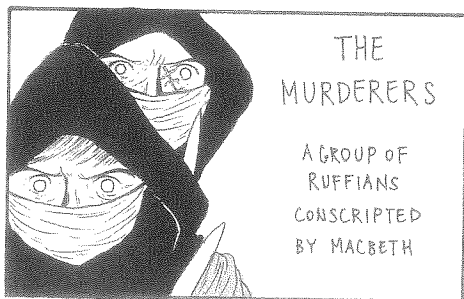
LENNOX

A SCOTTISH
NOBLEMAN



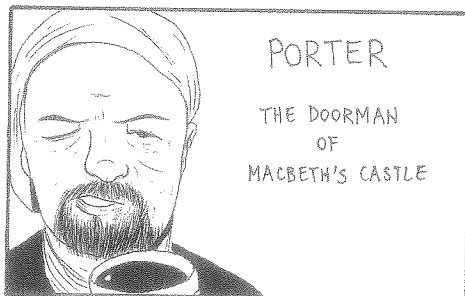
ROSS

A SCOTTISH
NOBLEMAN



THE
MURDERERS

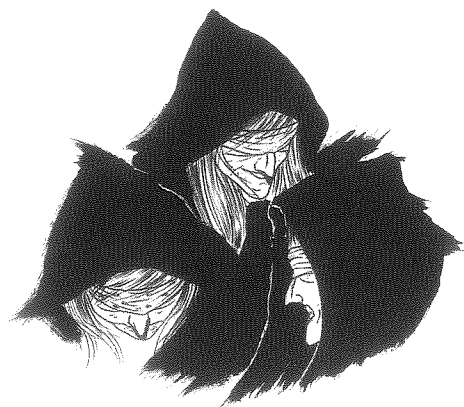
A GROUP OF
RUFFIANS
CONSCRIPTED
BY MACBETH



PORTER

THE DOORMAN
OF
MACBETH'S CASTLE

ACT I



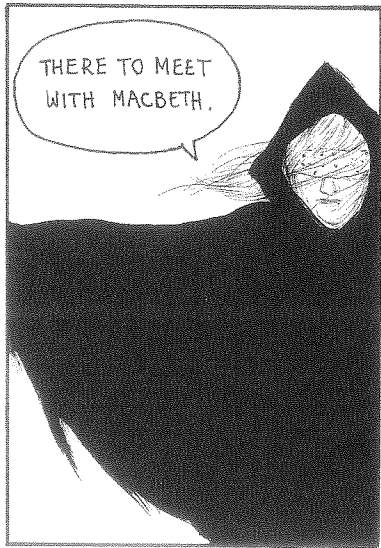




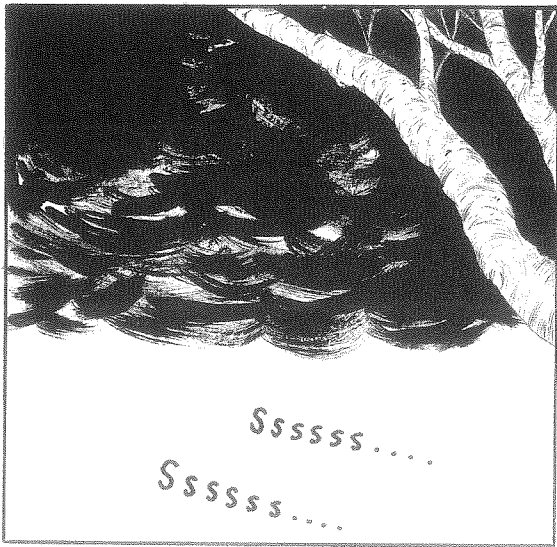
THAT WILL HAPPEN
BEFORE SUNSET.

WHERE SHOULD WE MEET?

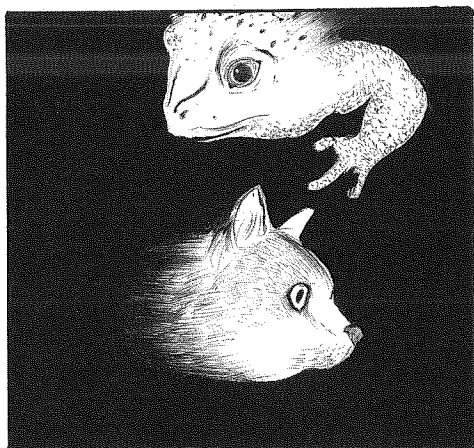
ON THE OPEN
WASTELAND.



THERE TO MEET
WITH MACBETH.

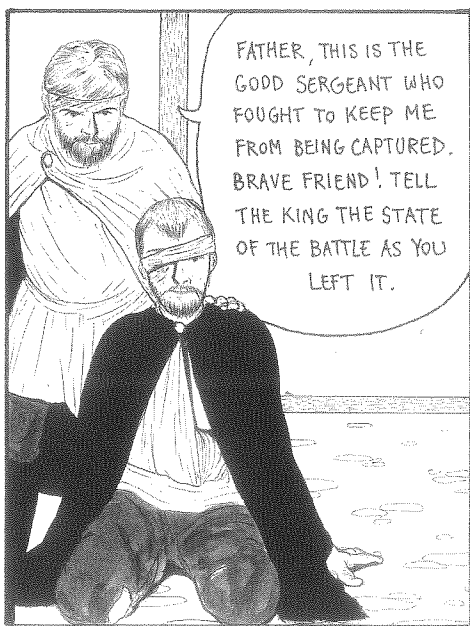
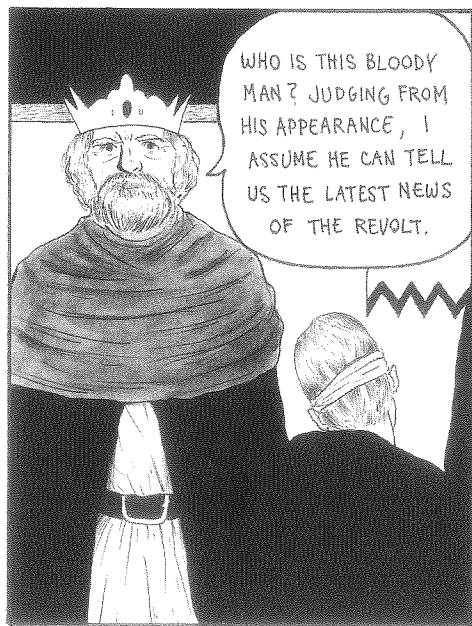
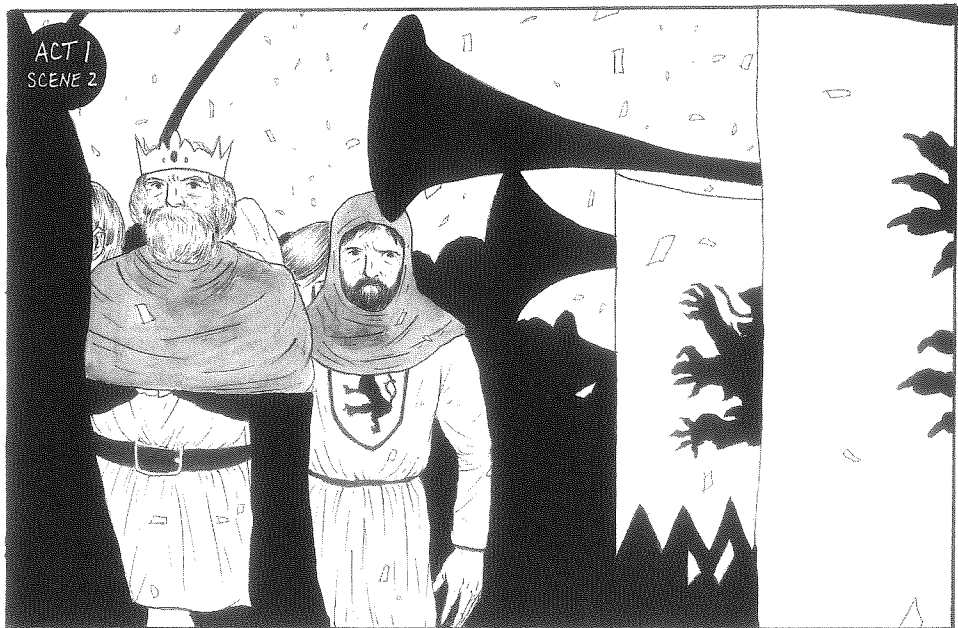


Ssssss....
Ssssss....



* GRAYMALKIN, PADDOCK= THE NAMES OF THE WITCHES' FAMILIARS, OR SPIRIT HELPERS

ACT I
SCENE 2





FOR A TIME YOU COULDN'T TELL WHO WOULD WIN, MACDONWALD'S REBELS AND YOUR MAJESTY'S ARMY WERE LIKE TWO EXHAUSTED SWIMMERS CLINGING TO EACH OTHER AND THRASHING IN THE SEA .

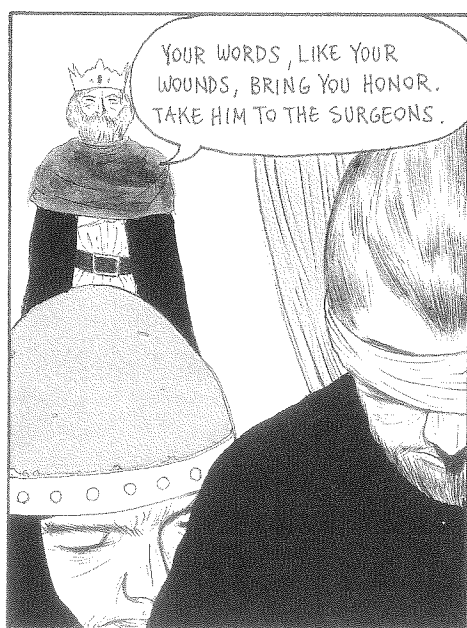
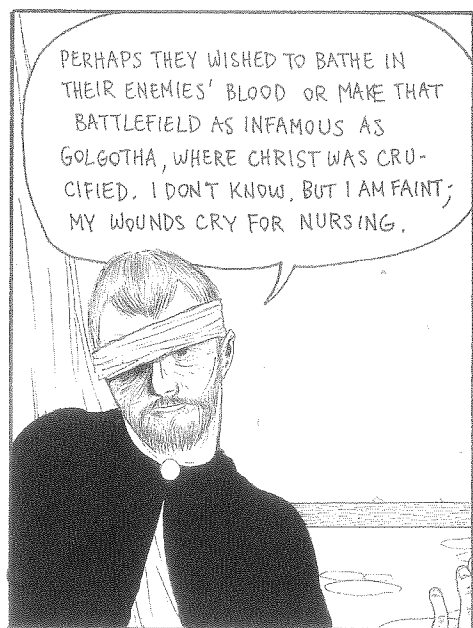
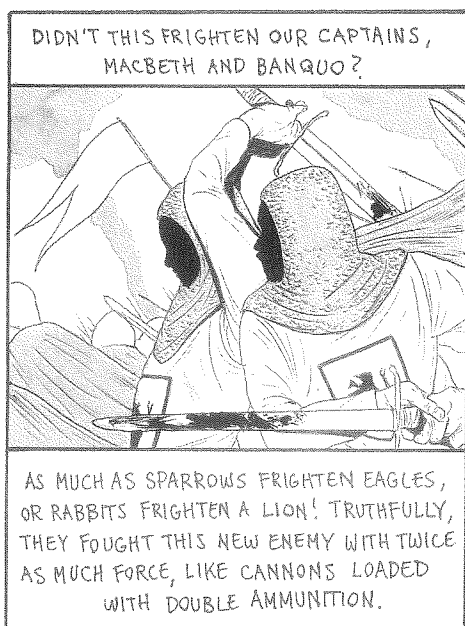
THE VILLAINOUS REBEL MACDONWALD HAD FOOT SOLDIERS AND HORSEMEN FROM IRELAND AND THE HEBRIDES, AND THE GODDESS FORTUNE SMILED CRUELLY AT HIS ENEMIES LIKE A REBEL'S WHORE .

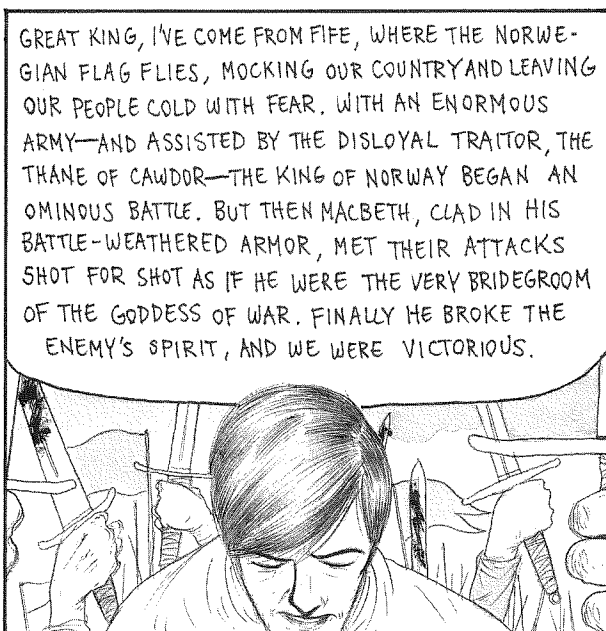


BUT ALL THOSE FORCES WEREN'T STRONG ENOUGH. SCORNING FORTUNE, BRAVE MACBETH SWUNG HIS BLOODY, SMOKING SWORD ACROSS THE BATTLEFIELD 'TIL HE FOUND MACDONWALD. HE DIDN'T STOP TO SAY FAREWELL OR SHAKE HIS HAND BEFORE HE SPLIT HIM OPEN —

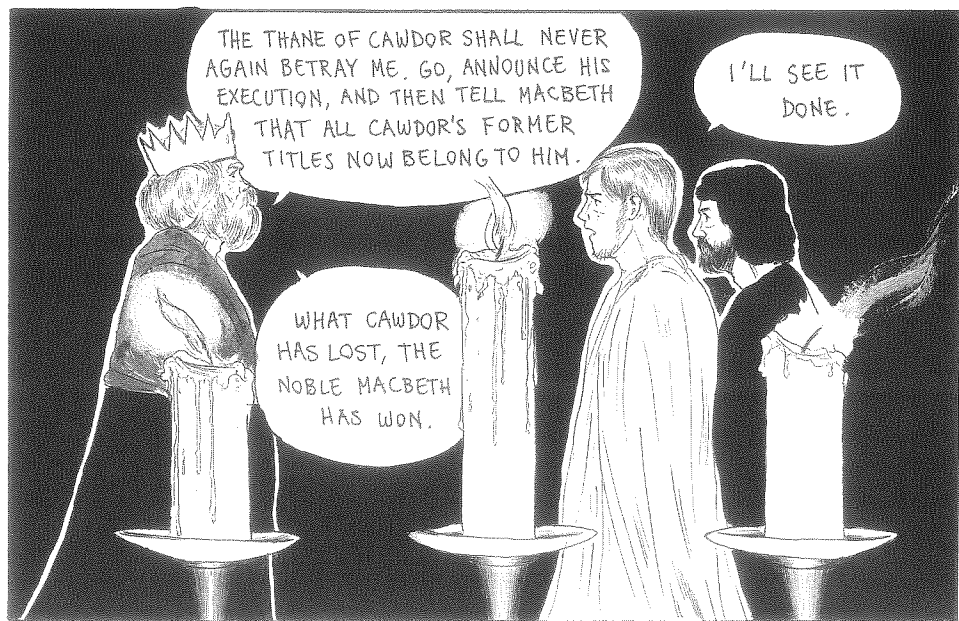
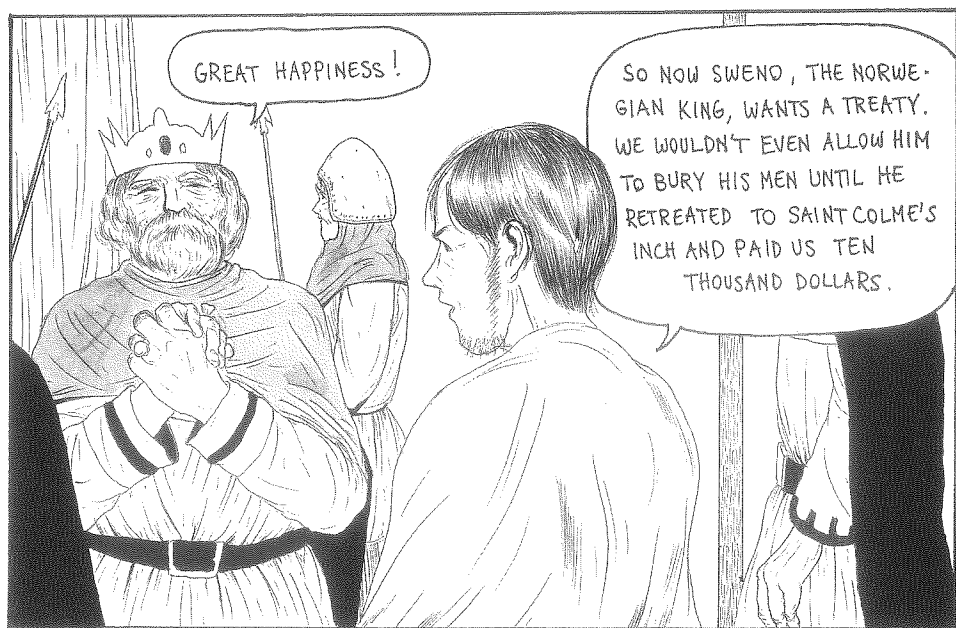
FROM NAVEL TO JAWBONE AND STUCK HIS HEAD ON OUR CASTLE WALLS .



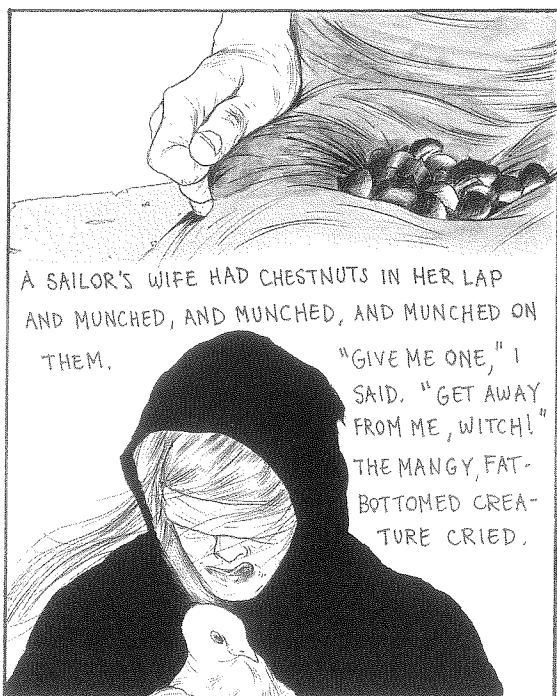




* THANE = SCOTTISH TITLE OF NOBILITY









I MYSELF CONTROL ALL THE OTHER WINDS, ALONG WITH THE PORTS FROM WHICH THEY BLOW AND ALL THE DIRECTIONS ON THE SAILOR'S COMPASS. I'LL DRAIN HIM DRY AS HAY.

SLEEP WON'T VISIT HIM, EITHER AT NIGHT OR DAY. HE WILL LIVE AS A CURSED MAN. FOR NINE TIMES NINE WEEKS HE WILL WASTE AWAY IN AGONY. I CANNOT MAKE HIS SHIP DIS-APPEAR, BUT I CAN WRACK IT WITH STORMS.

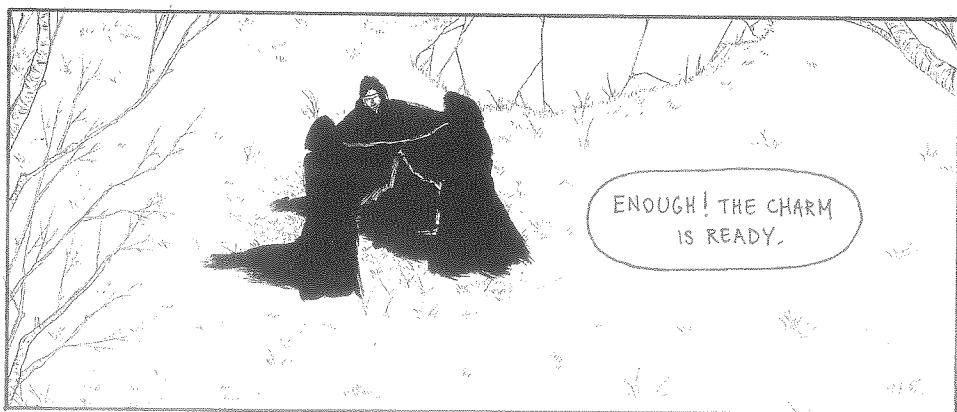


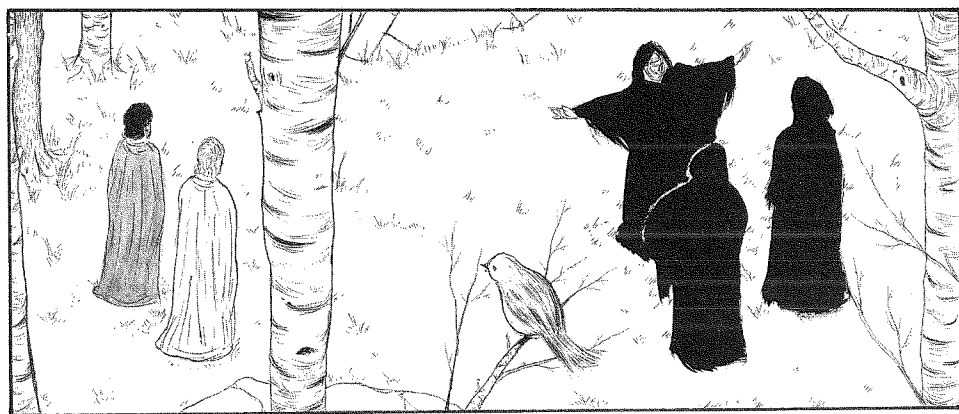
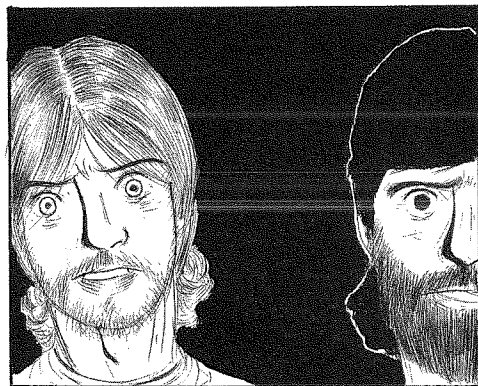
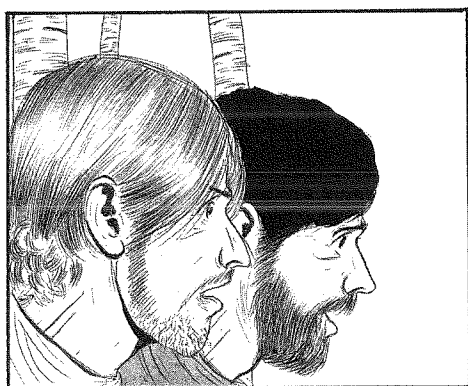
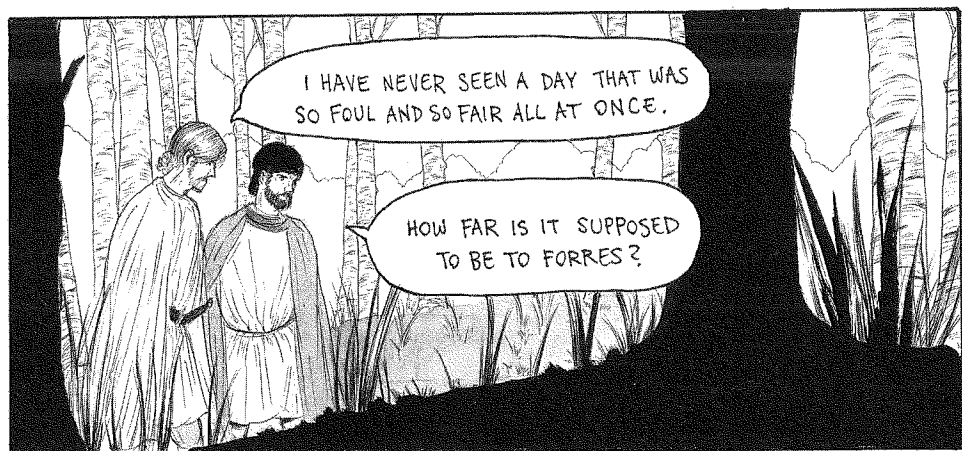
LOOK WHAT I HAVE HERE

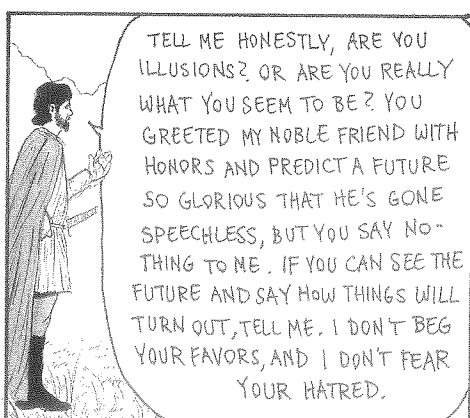
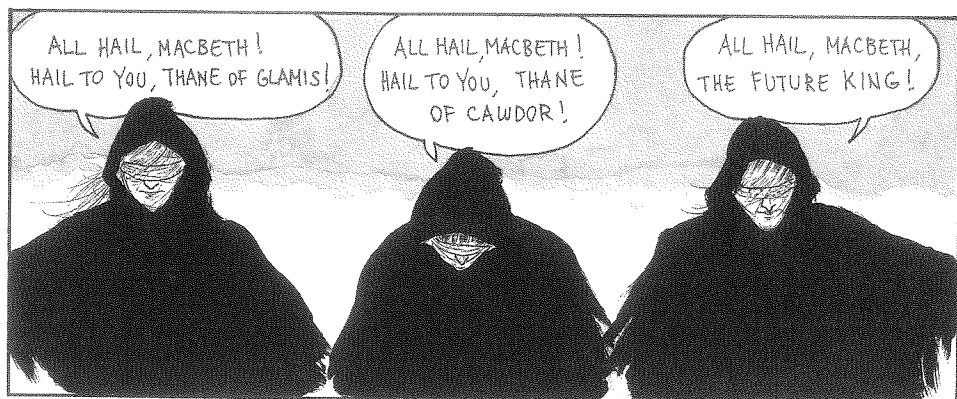
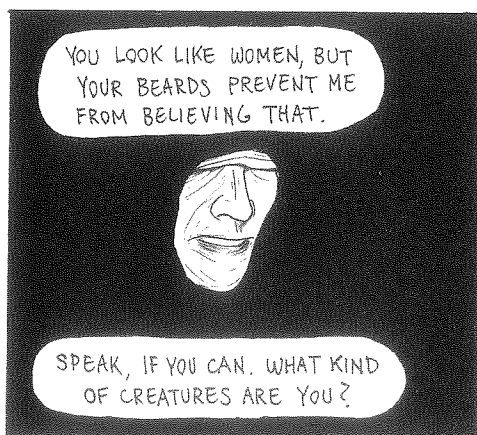
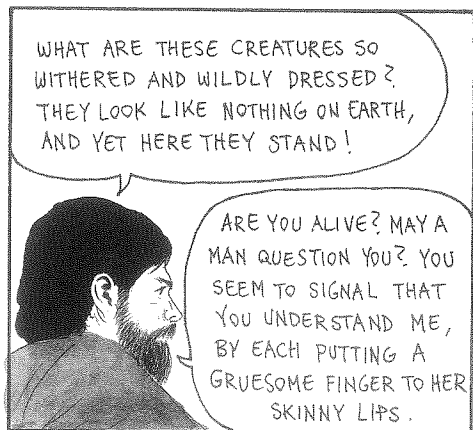
SHOW ME, SHOW ME.

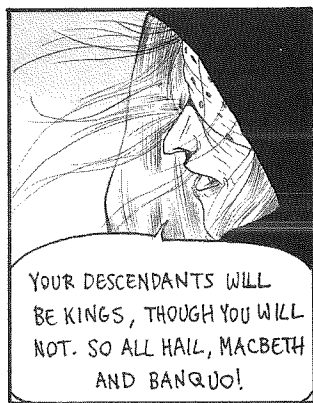
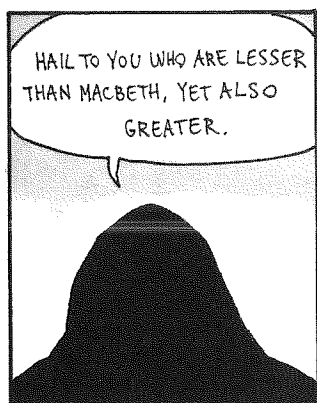


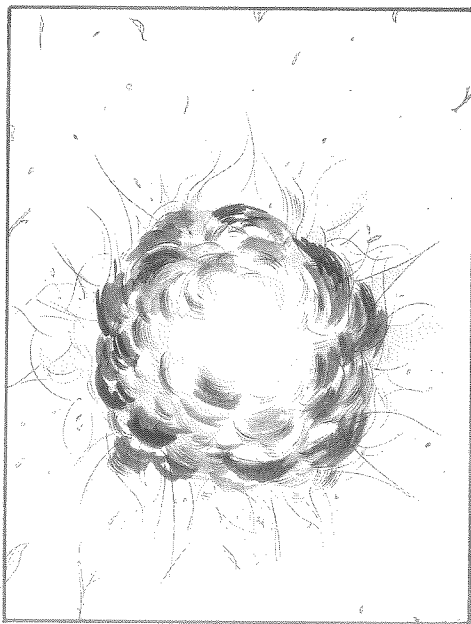
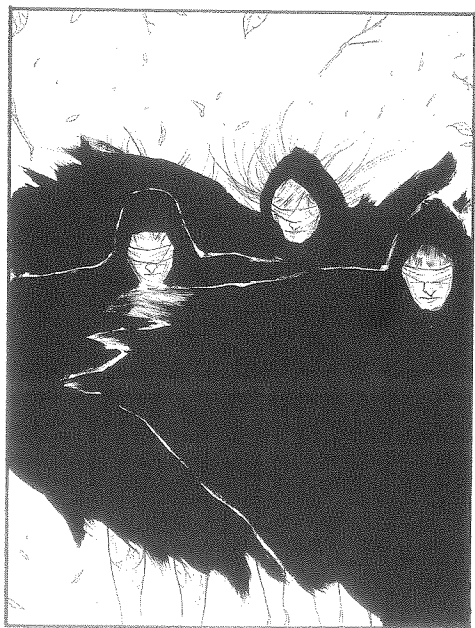
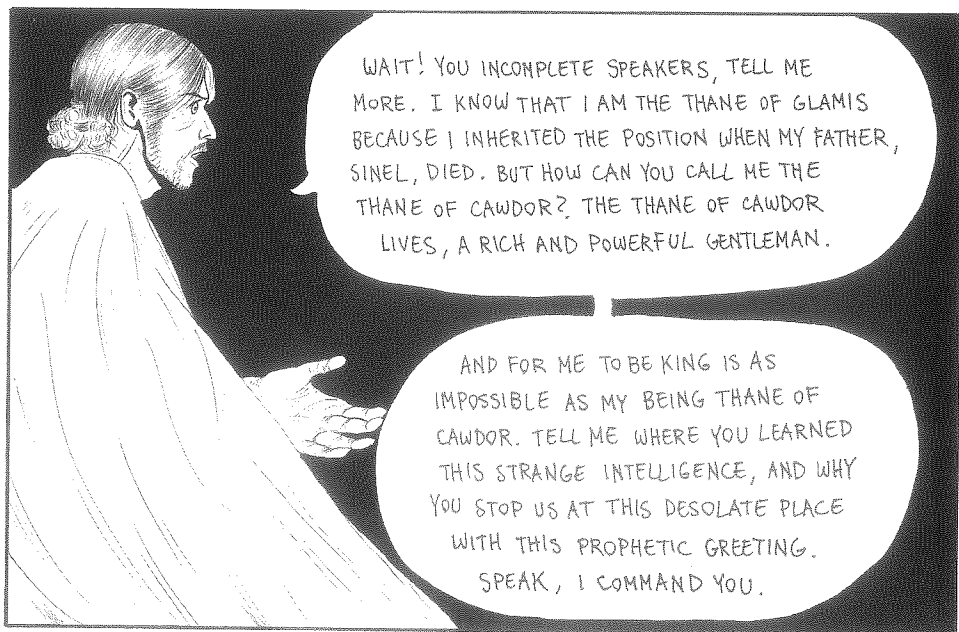
HERE I HAVE A PILOT'S THUMB, DROWNED AS HE DID COME.

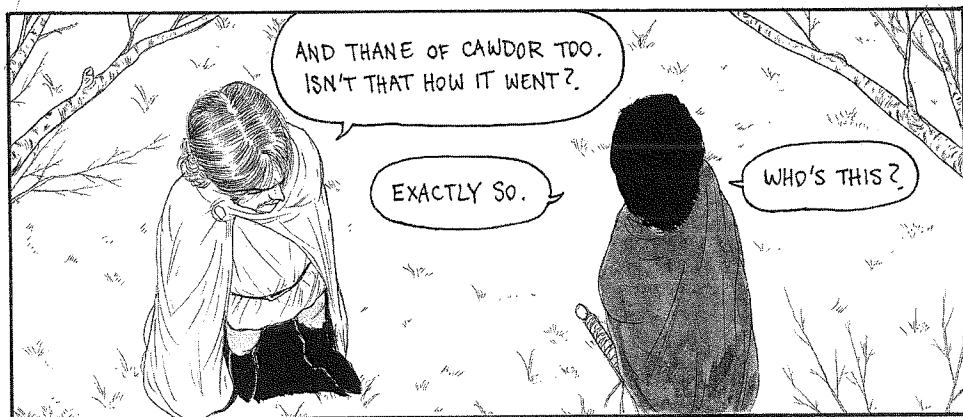
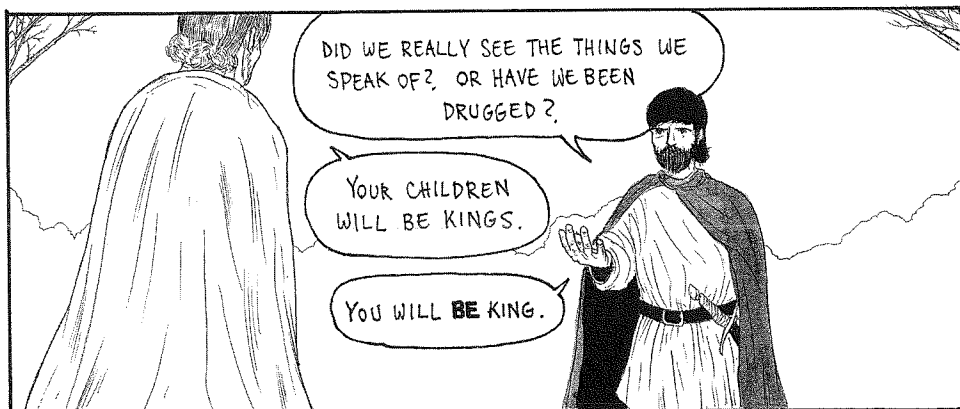
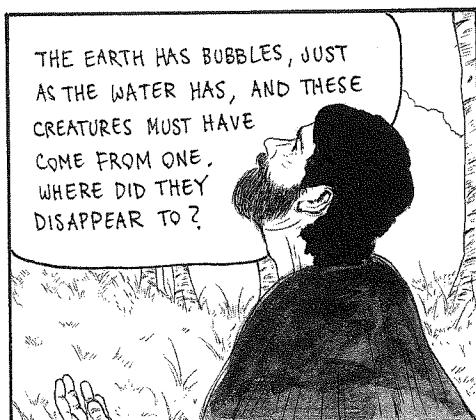












THE KING WAS HAPPY TO HEAR OF YOUR SUCCESS, MACBETH. WHENEVER HE CONSIDERS YOUR EXPLOITS AGAINST THE REBELS, HE BECOMES SO AMAZED THAT HE FALLS SPEECHLESS.

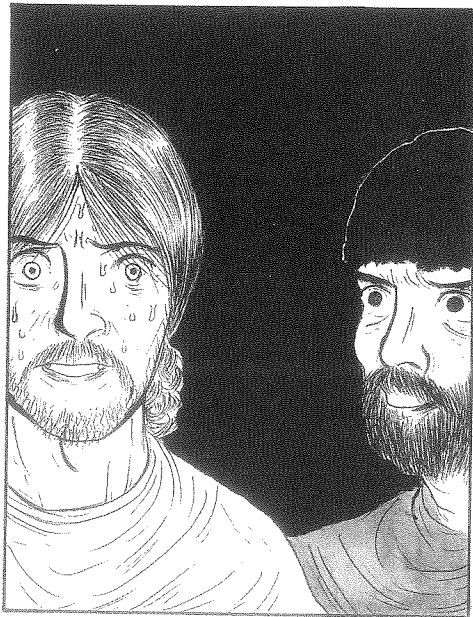
THEN HE IMAGINES HOW YOU FOUGHT THE ARMIES OF NORWAY ON THAT SAME DAY, NOT THE LEAST BIT AFRAID OF DEATH, EVEN AS YOU KILLED EVERYTHING AROUND YOU.

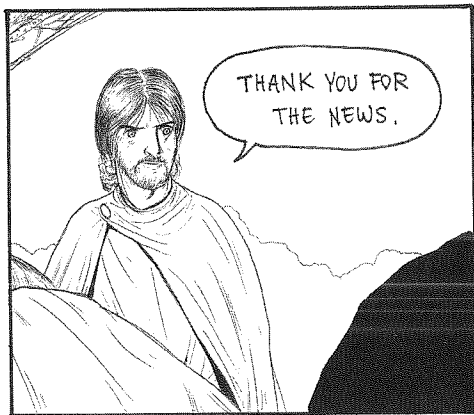
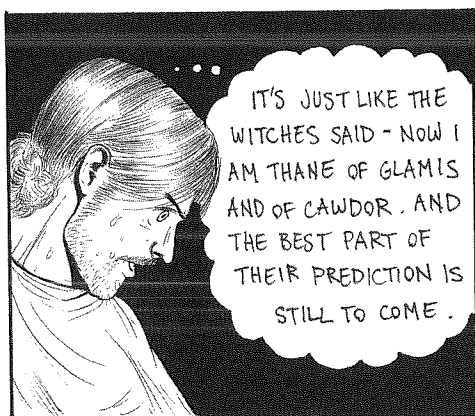
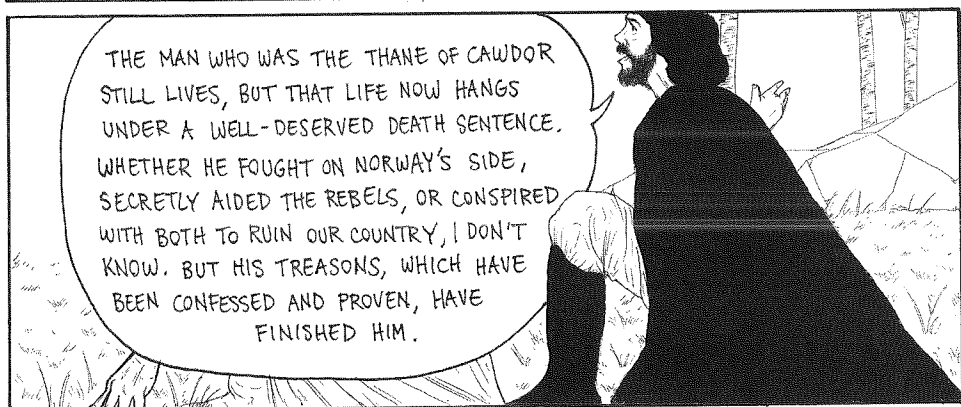
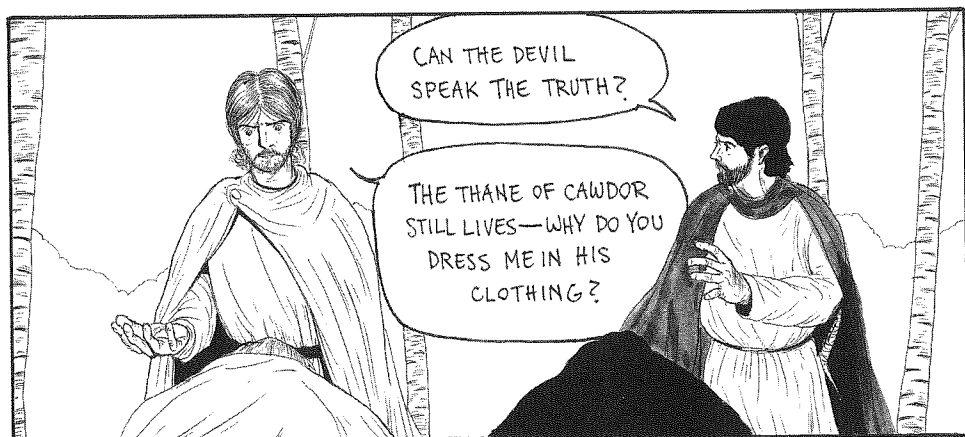
MESSENGERS CAME LIKE HAIL-STONES, POURING DOWN PRAISE FOR YOUR BRAVERY IN DEFENDING THE KINGDOM.

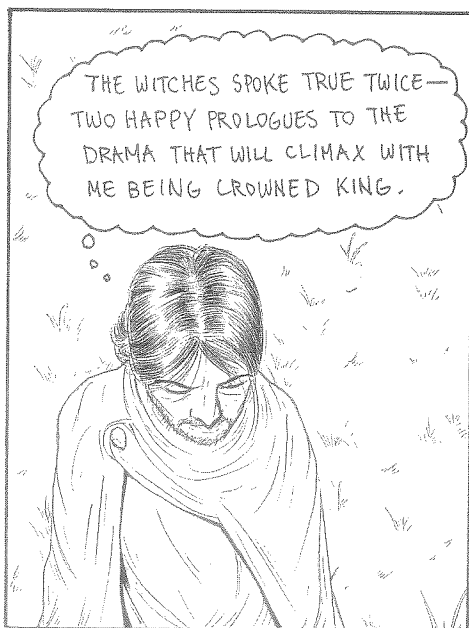
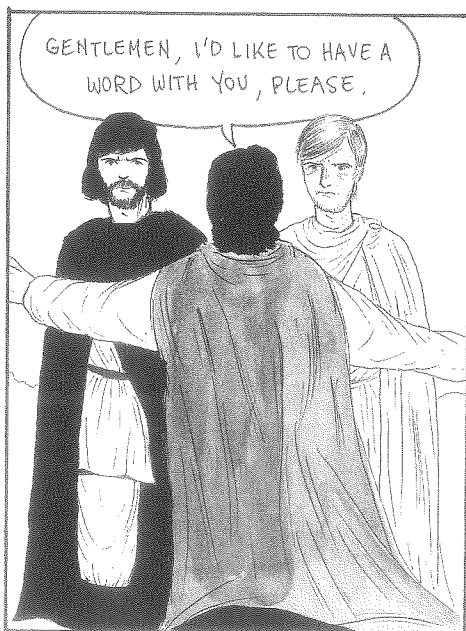
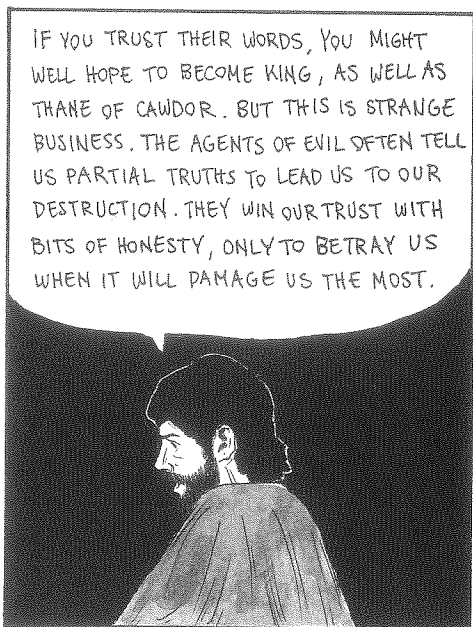
THE KING SENT US TO GIVE YOU HIS THANKS AND TO BRING YOU TO HIM. YOUR REAL REWARD WON'T COME FROM US.

AND AS A PLEDGE OF WHAT'S IN STORE FOR YOU, HE TOLD ME TO

CALL YOU THANE OF CAWDOR.
SO HAIL, THANE OF CAWDOR!
FOR THAT TITLE BELONGS TO YOU NOW.









THIS SUPERNATURAL TEMPTATION DOESN'T SEEM LIKE IT COULD BE WICKED, BUT IT CAN'T BE GOOD EITHER. IF IT WERE WICKED, WHY WAS I PROMISED AN ADVANCEMENT THAT THEN CAME TRUE?

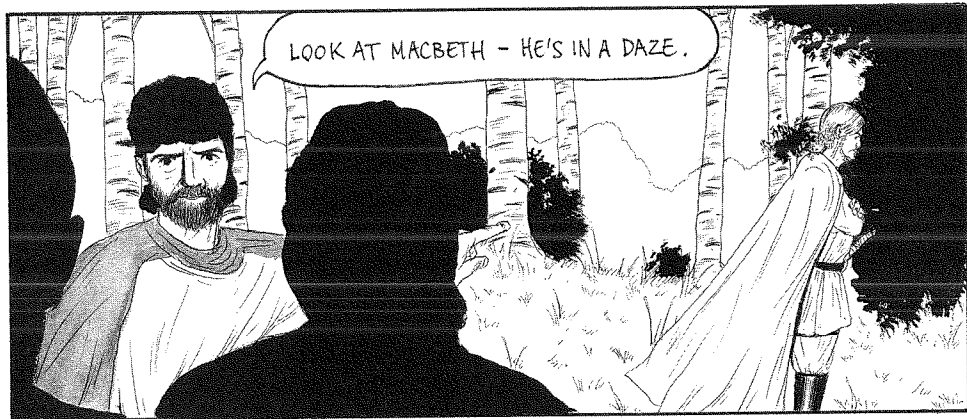


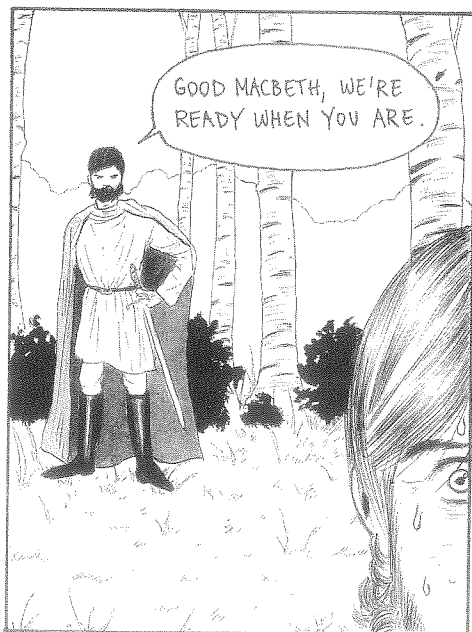
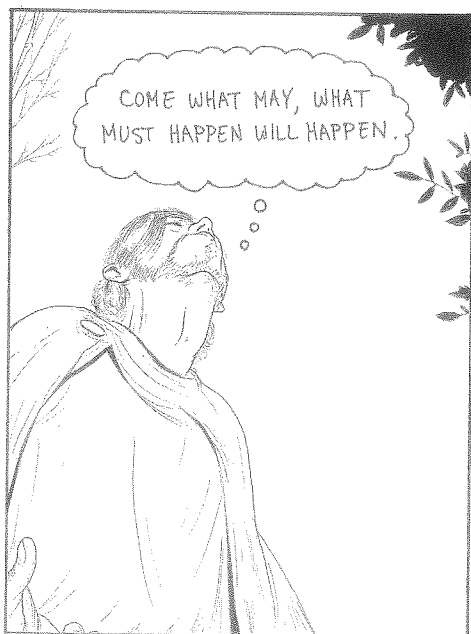
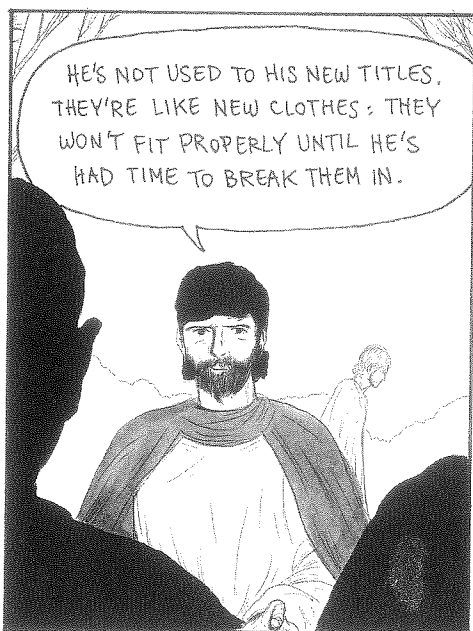
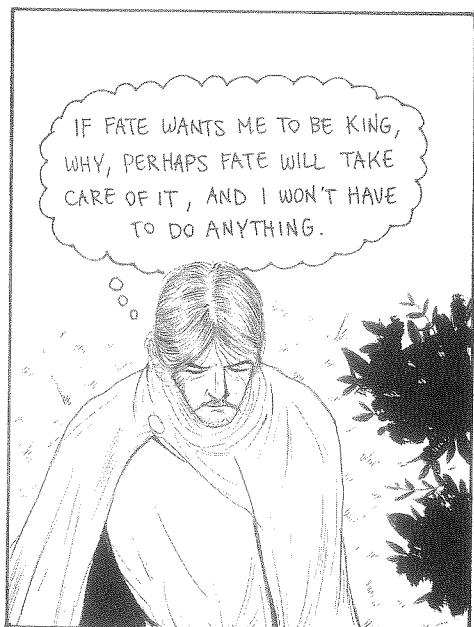
BUT IF IT WERE GOOD, THEN WHY DO I FIND MY THOUGHTS DRIFTING TO MURDER - AN IMAGE SO HORRIFYING THAT IT MAKES MY HAIR STAND ON END AND MY HEART POUND INSIDE MY CHEST?

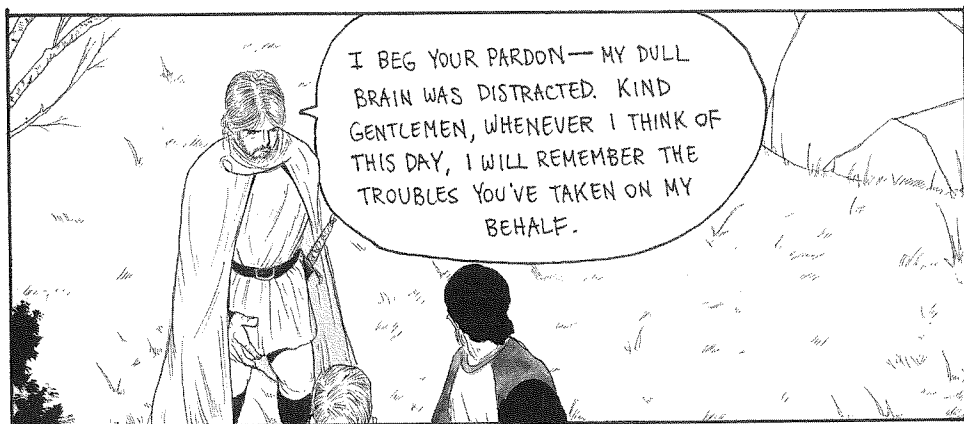
THE REAL DANGERS OF THE HERE AND NOW ARE LESS FRIGHTENING THAN THE HORRIBLE THINGS I IMAGINE.

MURDER IS STILL JUST A FANTASY, AND YET THE MERE THOUGHT OF COMMITTING IT SHAKES MY SOUL APART.

MY ABILITY TO ACT IS STIFLED BY MY THOUGHTS AND SPECULATIONS—THE ONLY THINGS THAT MATTER TO ME NOW ARE THINGS THAT DON'T REALLY EXIST.







ACT 1
SCENE 4



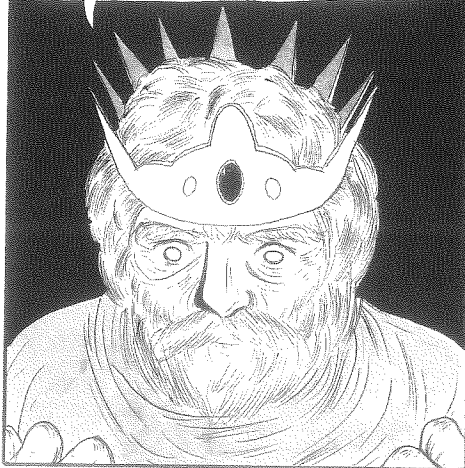
HAS THE FORMER THANE
OF CAWDOR BEEN EXECUTED
YET? HAVEN'T THE PEOPLE
IN CHARGE OF THAT MISSION
RETURNED YET?

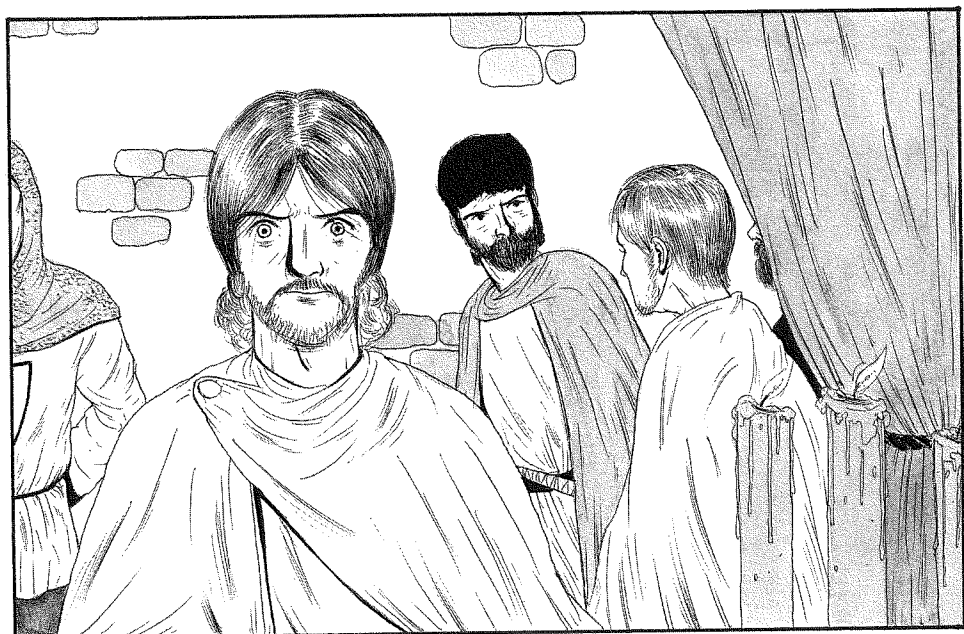
MY LORD, NOT YET. BUT I SPOKE WITH
SOMEONE WHO SAW CAWDOR DIE, AND
HE SAID THAT CAWDOR OPENLY CONFESSED
HIS TREASONS, BEGGED YOUR HIGHNESS
FORGIVENESS, AND REPENTED DEEPLY.

HE NEVER DID ANYTHING IN HIS WHOLE
LIFE THAT REFLECTED ON HIM SO WELL AS
THE WAY HE BEHAVED WHEN LEAVING THAT
LIFE. IT WAS AS IF HE HAD CAREFULLY
PREPARED HIMSELF TO TOSS AWAY HIS
MOST CHERISHED POSSESSION AS HE DIED,
AS IF IT WERE A WORTHLESS TRINKET.



THERE'S NO WAY TO READ A MAN'S
MIND BY LOOKING AT HIS FACE. I
TRUSTED CAWDOR COMPLETELY.





MY WORTHIEST KINSMAN! JUST THIS MOMENT I WAS FEELING GUILTY FOR THE INGRATITUDE I HAVE SHOWN YOU. YOU HAVE DONE SO MUCH FOR ME SO FAST THAT IT HAS BEEN IMPOSSIBLE TO REWARD YOU PROPERLY. IF YOU DESERVED LESS, THEN PERHAPS MY PAYMENT COULD HAVE MATCHED YOUR DEEDS.



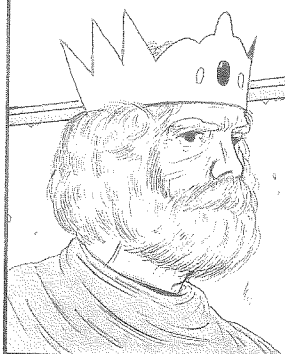
ALL I CAN SAY IS THAT I OWE YOU MORE THAN I CAN EVER REPAY.

THE OPPORTUNITY TO SERVE YOU IS ITS OWN REWARD. YOUR ONLY DUTY, YOUR HIGHNESS, IS TO ACCEPT OUR TRIBUTES.

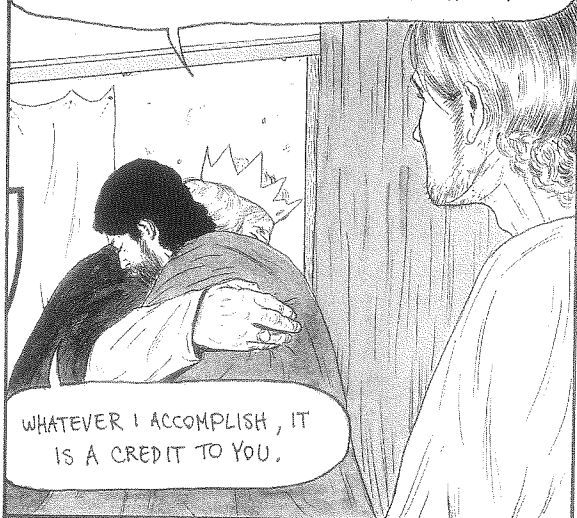
YOUR PEOPLE ARE LIKE YOUR CHILDREN OR YOUR SERVANTS - BY DOING EVERYTHING WE CAN TO PROTECT, LOVE, AND HONOR YOU, WE ONLY DO AS WE SHOULD.



YOU ARE WELCOME HERE, BY MAKING YOU THANE OF CAWDOR, I HAVE PLANTED THE SEEDS OF A GREAT CAREER FOR YOU, AND I WILL SEE TO IT THAT THEY GROW.



NOBLE BANQUO, YOU DESERVE NO LESS THAN MACBETH, AND EVERYONE SHOULD KNOW IT. LET ME EMBRACE YOU AND HOLD YOU IN MY HEART.

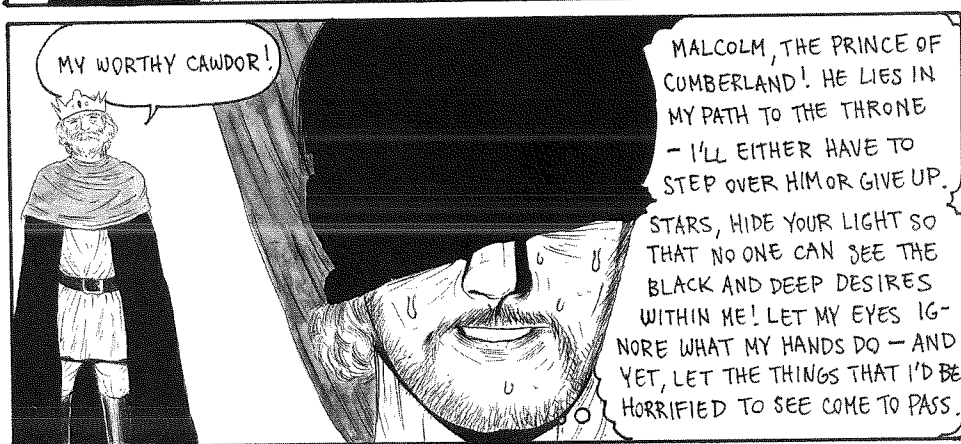
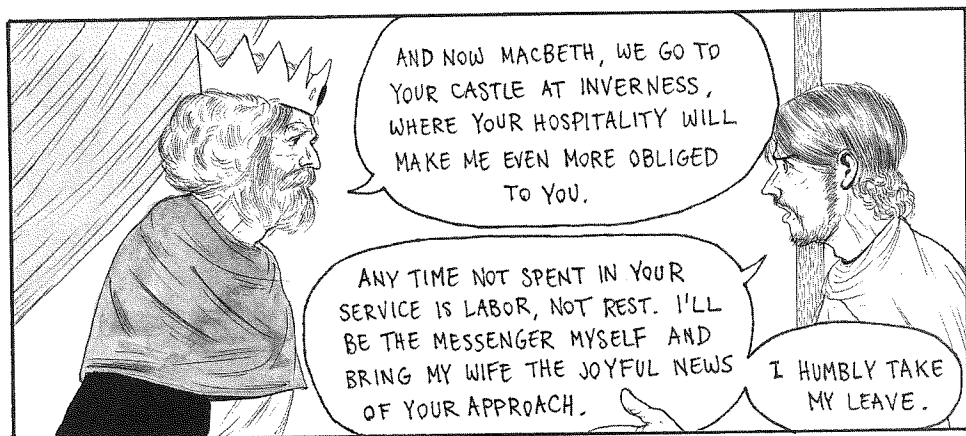


WHATEVER I ACCOMPLISH, IT IS A CREDIT TO YOU.

MY JOY IS SO OVERWHELMING IT BRINGS TEARS TO MY EYES. SONS, KINSMEN, LORDS, AND ALL THOSE CLOSEST TO ME WILL BE MY WITNESSES AS I BESTOW MY KINGDOM ON MY ELDEST SON, MALCOLM. TODAY I NAME HIM THE PRINCE OF CUMBERLAND.

BUT MALCOLM SHALL NOT RECEIVE HONORS ALONE - TITLES OF NOBILITY WILL SHINE LIKE STARS ON ALL WHO DESERVE THEM.



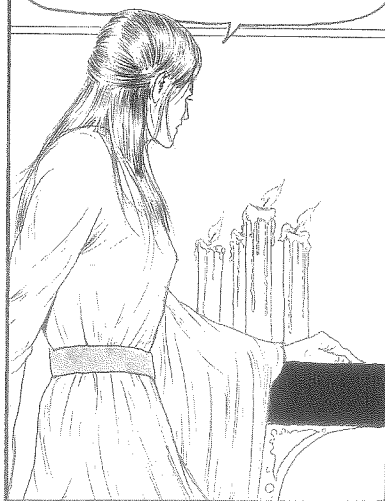


ACT I
SCENE 5



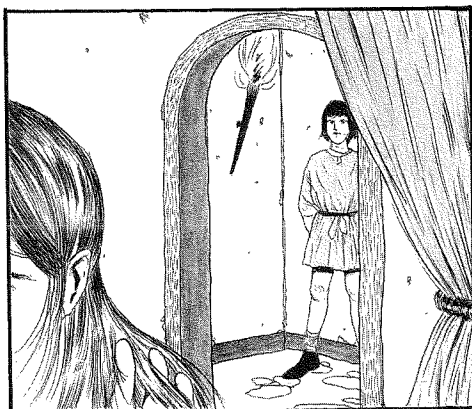
I MET THEM ON THE DAY OF MY VICTORY
IN BATTLE, AND I HAVE SINCE LEARNED THAT
THEIR KNOWLEDGE FAR SURPASSES OUR MOR-
TAL UNDERSTANDING. WHEN I BURNED TO
QUESTION THEM FURTHER, THEY TURNED
INTO AIR AND VANISHED. WHILE I STOOD
SPELLBOUND, MESSENGERS FROM THE KING
ARRIVED AND GREETED ME AS THE THANE
OF CAWDOR, WHICH IS PRECISELY HOW THE
WEIRD SISTERS HAD SALUTED ME BEFORE
HAILING ME AS THE FUTURE KING. ALL THIS
I HAVE THOUGHT TO TELL YOU, MY DEAREST
PARTNER IN GREATNESS, SO THAT YOU COULD
REJOICE ALONG WITH ME, RATHER THAN
REMAINING IGNORANT OF THE GREATNESS
THAT IS PROMISED TO YOU. KEEP IT A
SECRET IN YOUR HEART, AND FAREWELL

YOU ARE THANE OF GLAMIS AND
CAWDOR, AND YOU **WILL** BE KING,
AS PROMISED. BUT I WORRY WHETHER
YOU HAVE WHAT IT TAKES TO SEIZE
THE CROWN. YOU ARE TOO FULL OF
THE MILK OF HUMAN KINDNESS TO
STRIKE AGGRESSIVELY AT THE
FIRST OPPORTUNITY.

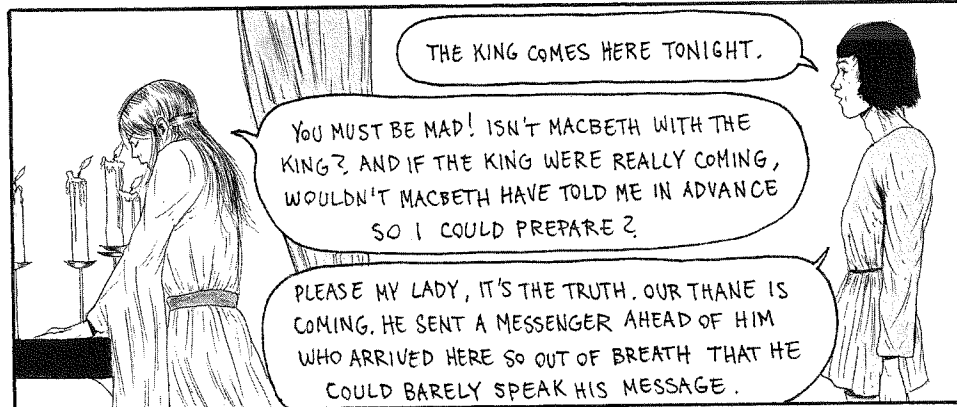


YOU WANT TO BE POWERFUL, AND YOU DON'T LACK AMBITION, BUT YOU LACK THE WICKEDNESS THAT SHOULD ACCOMPANY THAT AMBITION. THE GLORY YOU WISH FOR, YOU WANT TO ACHIEVE RIGHT-EOUSLY. YOU WON'T CHEAT, YET YOU WANT WHAT DOESN'T BELONG TO YOU. YOU WISH FOR THAT THING, GREAT GLAMIS, THAT CALLS YOU TO COMMIT A TERRIBLE ACT -

AND YOU WISH TO SEE THAT ACT DONE BUT ARE TOO AFRAID TO COMMIT IT YOURSELF. HURRY HOME AND I WILL POUR MY FIGHTING SPIRIT INTO YOUR EAR, AND WITH MY BRAVE WORDS I'LL DRIVE AWAY EVERY-THING THAT STANDS BETWEEN YOU AND THE GOLDEN CROWN, WHICH FATE AND WITCHCRAFT HAVE ALREADY PLACED ON YOUR HEAD.



WHAT NEWS DO YOU BRING?



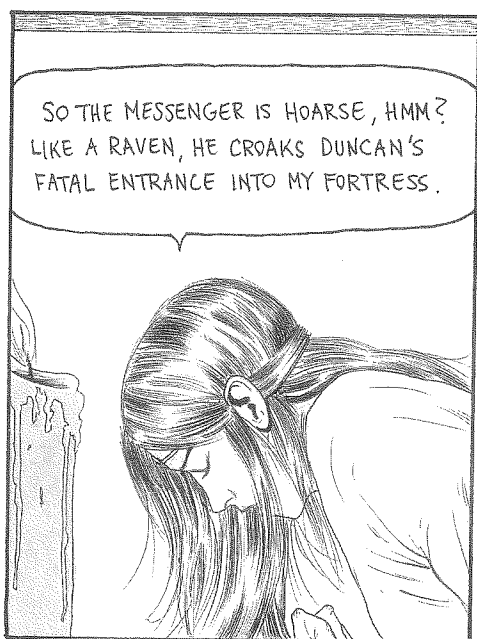
THE KING COMES HERE TONIGHT.

YOU MUST BE MAD! ISN'T MACBETH WITH THE KING? AND IF THE KING WERE REALLY COMING, WOULDN'T MACBETH HAVE TOLD ME IN ADVANCE SO I COULD PREPARE?

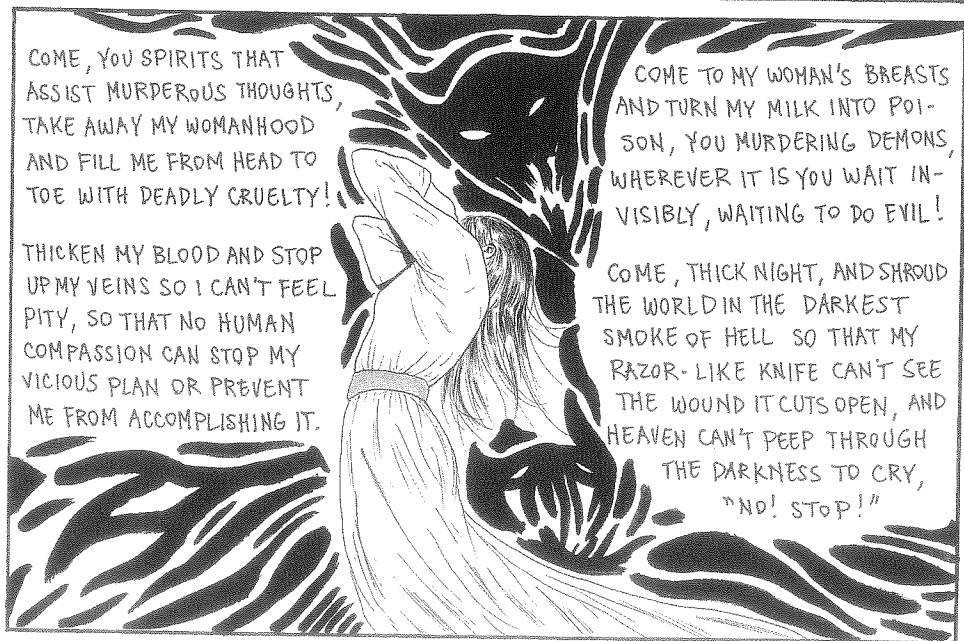
PLEASE MY LADY, IT'S THE TRUTH. OUR THANE IS COMING. HE SENT A MESSENGER AHEAD OF HIM WHO ARRIVED HERE SO OUT OF BREATH THAT HE COULD BARELY SPEAK HIS MESSAGE.



TAKE GOOD CARE
OF HIM, THEN. HE
BRINGS GREAT
NEWS.



SO THE MESSENGER IS HOARSE, HMM?
LIKE A RAVEN, HE CROAKS DUNCAN'S
FATAL ENTRANCE INTO MY FORTRESS.



COME, YOU SPIRITS THAT
ASSIST MURDEROUS THOUGHTS,
TAKE AWAY MY WOMANHOOD
AND FILL ME FROM HEAD TO
TOE WITH DEADLY CRUELTY!

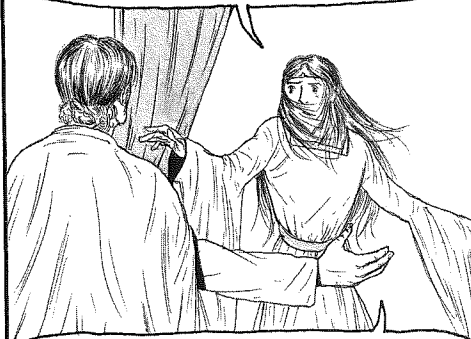
THICKEN MY BLOOD AND STOP
UP MY VEINS SO I CAN'T FEEL
PITY, SO THAT NO HUMAN
COMPASSION CAN STOP MY
VICIOUS PLAN OR PREVENT
ME FROM ACCOMPLISHING IT.

COME TO MY WOMAN'S BREASTS
AND TURN MY MILK INTO POI-
SON, YOU MURDERING DEMONS,
WHEREVER IT IS YOU WAIT IN-
VISIBLY, WAITING TO DO EVIL!

COME, THICK NIGHT, AND SHROUD
THE WORLD IN THE DARKEST
SMOKE OF HELL SO THAT MY
RAZOR-LIKE KNIFE CAN'T SEE
THE WOUND IT CUTS OPEN, AND
HEAVEN CAN'T PEEP THROUGH
THE DARKNESS TO CRY,
"NO! STOP!"



GREAT GLAMIS! WORTHY CAWDOR! AND
SOON GREATER THAN BOTH, BY THE WITCHES'
PROCLAMATION!



YOUR LETTER HAS TRANSPORTED ME
BEYOND THE PRESENT MOMENT, WHERE
I WAIT IN IGNORANCE, AND MAKES ME
FEEL THE FUTURE!

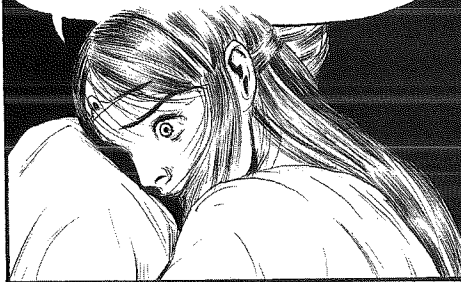


MY DEAREST LOVE, DUNCAN
COMES HERE TONIGHT.

AND WHEN DOES HE LEAVE?

TOMORROW,
ACCORDING TO
HIS PLAN.

THAT DAY WILL NEVER COME!
YOUR FACE, MY LORD, IS AN OPEN BOOK
THAT TELLS STRANGE STORIES IN ORDER
TO DECEIVE PEOPLE, YOU MUST APPEAR AS
THEY EXPECT YOU TO LOOK. GREET THE
KING WITH A WELCOMING EXPRESSION IN
YOUR EYES, YOUR HANDS, AND YOUR WORDS.
YOU SHOULD LOOK LIKE AN INNOCENT
FLOWER, BUT BE LIKE THE SERPENT THAT
HIDES UNDERNEATH.





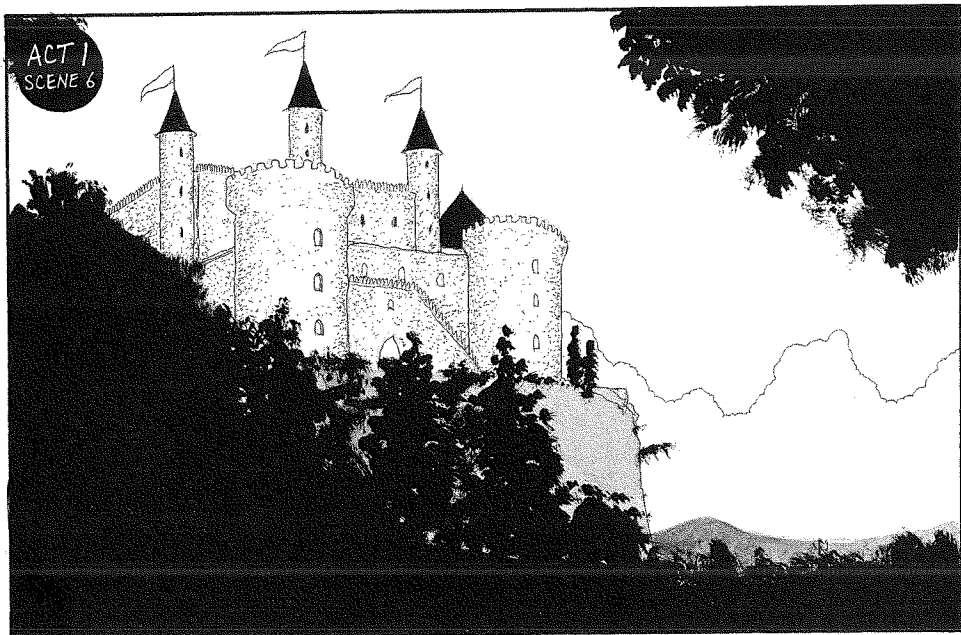
THE KING IS COMING AND
MUST BE CARED FOR. LET ME
HANDLE TONIGHT'S PREPA-
RATIONS, FOR TONIGHT WILL
CHANGE ALL OUR NIGHTS AND
DAYS TO COME.

WE WILL SPEAK ABOUT
THIS FURTHER.



JUST GREET OUR GUESTS
WITH A CLEAR FACE.
LOOKING TROUBLED
ALWAYS AROUSES SUSPICION.
LEAVE ALL THE REST
TO ME.

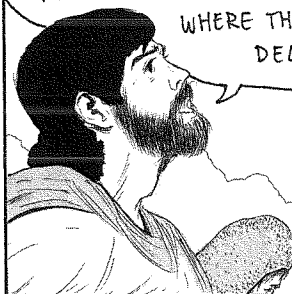
ACT I
SCENE 6

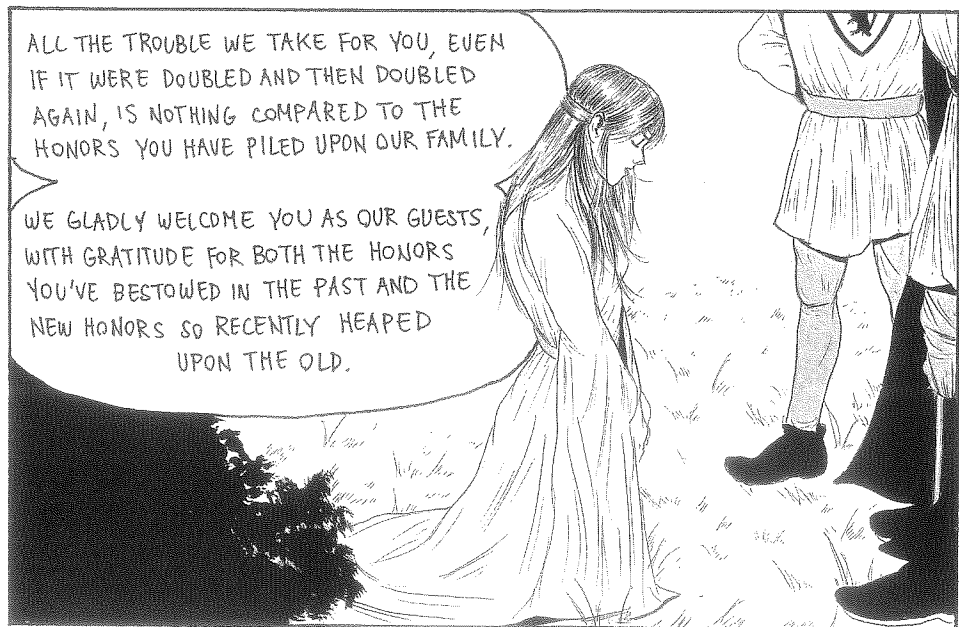
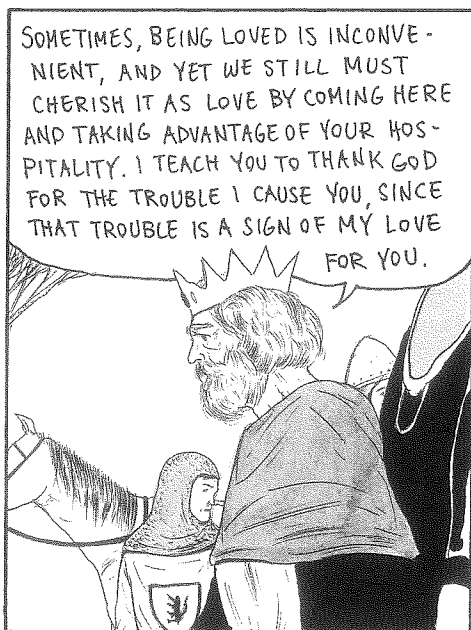


THIS CASTLE IS IN A
PLEASANT PLACE. THE
SWEET AIR APPEALS
TO MY FINER
SENSES.



THIS SUMMER BIRD, THE HOUSE MARTIN,
LOVINGLY BUILDS HIS NESTS HERE,
PROVING THAT THE BREATH OF HEAVEN
BLOWS THROUGH INVERNESS'S BREEZES.
THERE ISN'T A SINGLE PROTRUSION IN
THE CASTLE WALLS THAT DOESN'T HAVE
A BIRD'S BED OR CRADLE HANGING
FROM IT. I'VE OBSERVED THAT THESE
BIRDS ALWAYS BREED AND HAUNT
WHERE THE AIR IS
DELICATE.

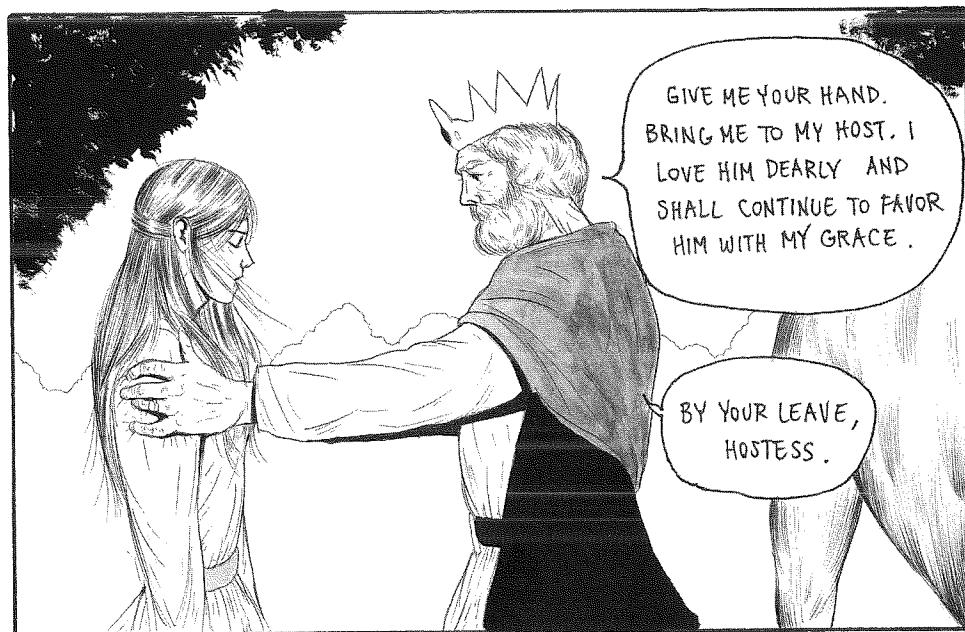




WHERE IS MACBETH, THE THANE OF Cawdor? WE FOLLOWED CLOSELY ON HIS HORSE'S HEELS AND HAD HOPED TO ARRIVE HERE BEFORE HIM, BUT HE RIDES SWIFTLY. NO DOUBT HIS GREAT LOVE FOR YOU, WHICH IS AS SHARP AS HIS SPURS, HELPED HIM SPEED BEFORE US.

FAIR AND NOBLE HOSTESS, WE ARE YOUR GUESTS TONIGHT.

WE ARE YOUR SERVANTS, YOUR HIGHNESS, AND AS ALWAYS OUR HOUSE AND OUR SELVES ARE AT YOUR DISPOSAL. FOR AFTER ALL, WE KEEP ALL THIS IN YOUR TRUST, AND WE'RE GLAD TO RETURN TO YOU WHAT'S YOURS.



GIVE ME YOUR HAND. BRING ME TO MY HOST. I LOVE HIM DEARLY AND SHALL CONTINUE TO FAVOR HIM WITH MY GRACE.

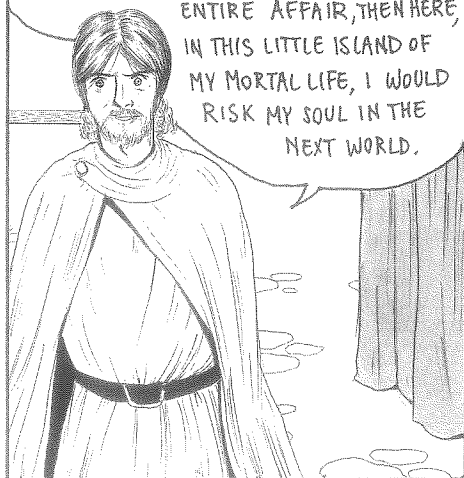
BY YOUR LEAVE, HOSTESS.

ACT I
SCENE 7



IF DOING THE DEED WOULD END THIS BUSINESS, THEN IT WOULD BE BEST TO DO IT QUICKLY. IF THE ASSASSINATION COULD SWEEP MY FUTURE CLEAR, LIKE A NET... IF ONLY THIS MURDER COULD BE THE BE-ALL AND END-ALL OF THIS

ENTIRE AFFAIR, THEN HERE, IN THIS LITTLE ISLAND OF MY MORTAL LIFE, I WOULD RISK MY SOUL IN THE NEXT WORLD.



BUT CRIMES SUCH AS THESE ALWAYS HAVE PUNISHMENTS IN THIS WORLD, IN THAT OUR VIOLENCE SIMPLY TEACHES BLOODY LESSONS TO OTHERS - AND THEN THOSE STUDENTS RETURN TO PLAGUE THEIR TEACHERS. JUSTICE, BEING FAIR-MINDED, FORCES US TO DRINK FROM OUR OWN POISONED CUP.

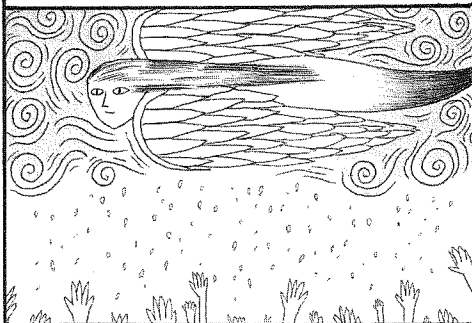


THE KING TRUSTS ME TWICE OVER.
FIRST, AS HIS KINSMAN AND SUBJECT, I
AM SWORN TO PROTECT HIM.
AND AS HIS HOST, I SHOULD BE BARRING
THE DOOR AGAINST THE MURDERER, NOT
WIELDING THE KNIFE MYSELF!
BESIDES, DUNCAN HAS WORN HIS AUTHORITY
SO MILDLY AND KEPT HIMSELF SO PURE THAT
WHEN HE DIES, HIS VIRTUES WILL TRUMPET
LIKE ANGELS AGAINST THE WICKEDNESS

OF HIS
MURDER.



PITY, LIKE A NAKED NEWBORN BABE, WILL
RIDE THE STORMY WINDS—OR ELSE WINGED
ANGELS ON INVISIBLE HORSES WILL BLOW
NEWS OF THE HORRIBLE DEED INTO EVERY



EYE, SO THAT THE PEOPLE'S TEARS
DROWN THE AIR. I HAVE NOTHING TO
SPUR ME INTO CAREFUL ACTION. ALL I
HAVE IS THIS WILD AMBITION, WHICH MIGHT
MAKE ME VAULT TOO HIGH ONLY TO
CRASH ON THE OTHER SIDE.



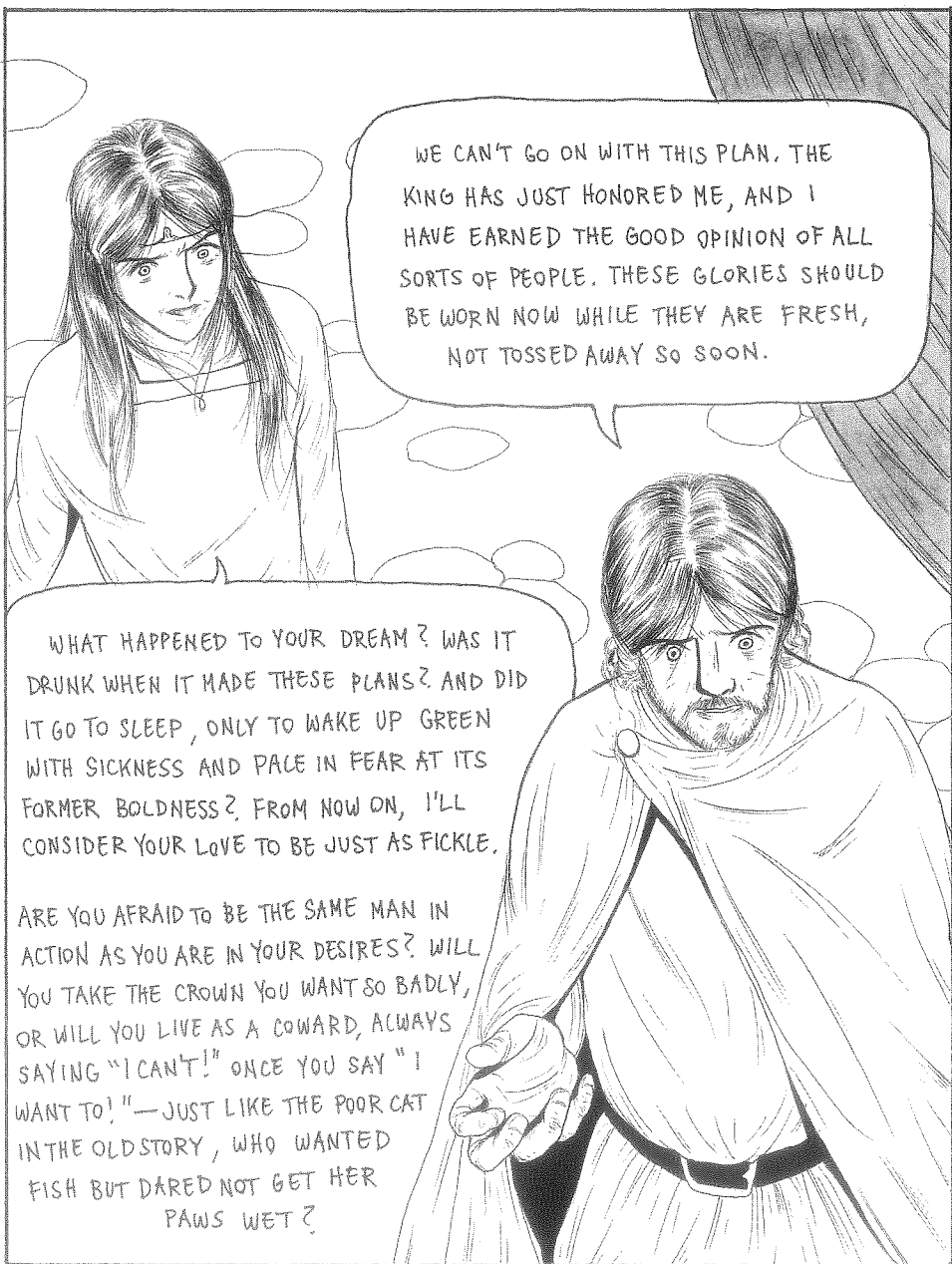
WHAT NEWS DO YOU HAVE?

HE HAS ALMOST FINISHED
DINNER. WHY DID YOU LEAVE
THE BANQUET HALL?

HAS HE ASKED FOR ME?

DON'T YOU KNOW
HE HAS?

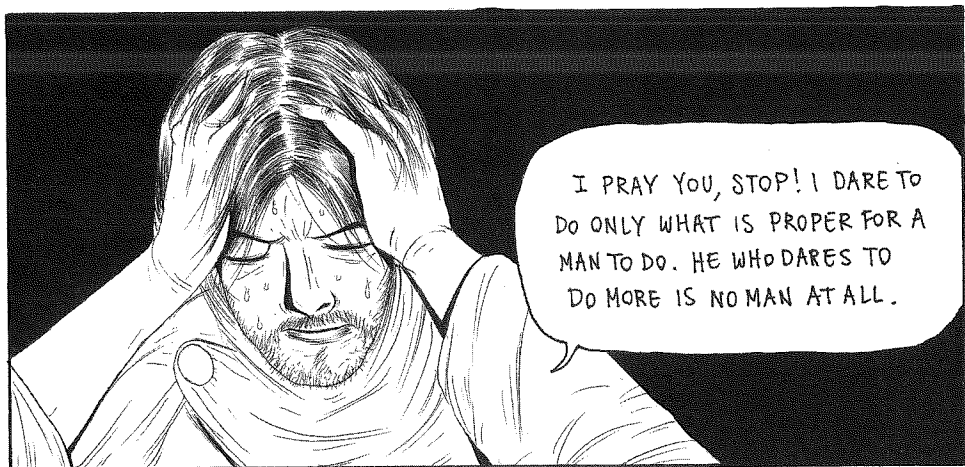




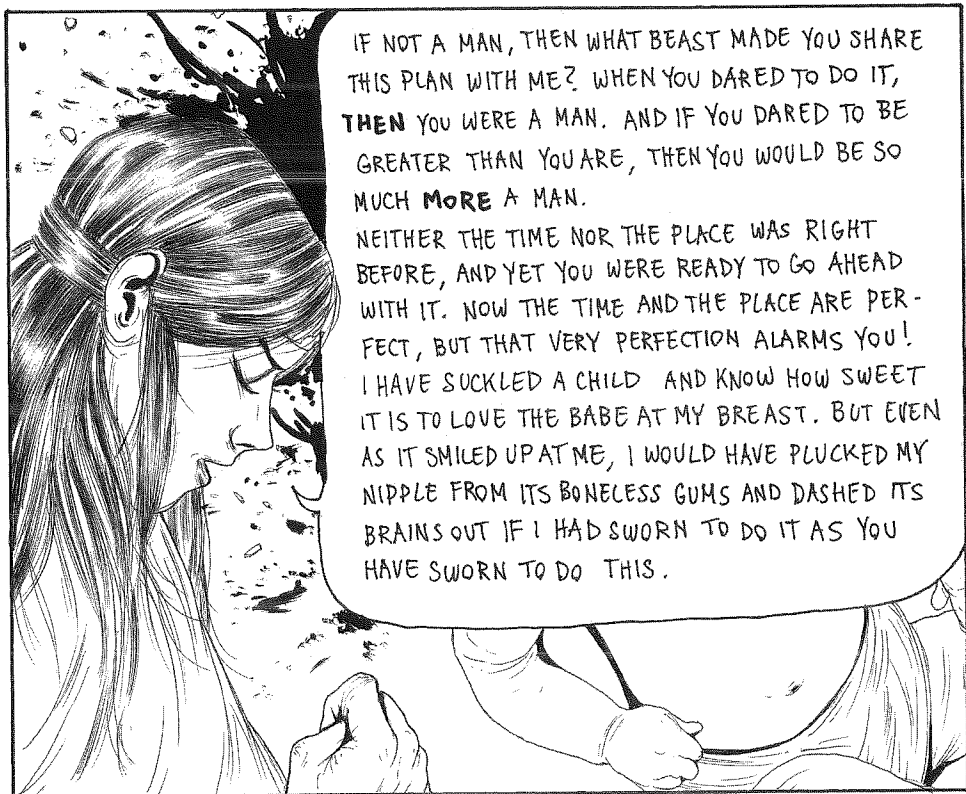
WE CAN'T GO ON WITH THIS PLAN. THE KING HAS JUST HONORED ME, AND I HAVE EARNED THE GOOD OPINION OF ALL SORTS OF PEOPLE. THESE GLORIES SHOULD BE WORN NOW WHILE THEY ARE FRESH, NOT TOSSED AWAY SO SOON.

WHAT HAPPENED TO YOUR DREAM? WAS IT DRUNK WHEN IT MADE THESE PLANS? AND DID IT GO TO SLEEP, ONLY TO WAKE UP GREEN WITH SICKNESS AND PALE IN FEAR AT ITS FORMER BOLDNESS? FROM NOW ON, I'LL CONSIDER YOUR LOVE TO BE JUST AS FICKLE.

ARE YOU AFRAID TO BE THE SAME MAN IN ACTION AS YOU ARE IN YOUR DESIRES? WILL YOU TAKE THE CROWN YOU WANT SO BADLY, OR WILL YOU LIVE AS A COWARD, ALWAYS SAYING "I CAN'T!" ONCE YOU SAY "I WANT TO!"—JUST LIKE THE POOR CAT IN THE OLD STORY, WHO WANTED FISH BUT DARED NOT GET HER PAWS WET?



I PRAY YOU, STOP! I DARE TO DO ONLY WHAT IS PROPER FOR A MAN TO DO. HE WHO DARES TO DO MORE IS NO MAN AT ALL.



IF NOT A MAN, THEN WHAT BEAST MADE YOU SHARE THIS PLAN WITH ME? WHEN YOU DARED TO DO IT, **THEN** YOU WERE A MAN. AND IF YOU DARED TO BE GREATER THAN YOU ARE, THEN YOU WOULD BE SO MUCH **MORE** A MAN.

NEITHER THE TIME NOR THE PLACE WAS RIGHT BEFORE, AND YET YOU WERE READY TO GO AHEAD WITH IT. NOW THE TIME AND THE PLACE ARE PERFECT, BUT THAT VERY PERFECTION ALARMS YOU! I HAVE SUCKLED A CHILD AND KNOW HOW SWEET IT IS TO LOVE THE BABE AT MY BREAST. BUT EVEN AS IT SMILED UP AT ME, I WOULD HAVE PLUCKED MY NIPPLE FROM ITS BONELESS GUMS AND DASHED ITS BRAINS OUT IF I HAD SWORN TO DO IT AS YOU HAVE SWORN TO DO THIS.

WE, FAIL? JUST LOCK YOUR COURAGE TO YOUR
CROSSBOW, AND WE CAN'T FAIL!

BUT IF WE FAIL —

WHEN DUNCAN IS ASLEEP — THE DAY'S HARD
JOURNEY ASSURES THAT HE WILL SLEEP
SOUNDLY — I'LL PLY HIS TWO CHAMBERLAINS
WITH WINE AND SONG SO THAT THEIR MEMORY
ESCAPES LIKE SMOKE THROUGH A CHIMNEY.
WHEN THEY LIE ASLEEP LIKE PIGS, SO DRUNK
THAT THEY'RE DEAD TO THE WORLD, WHAT
WON'T YOU AND I BE ABLE TO DO TO THE
UNGUARDED DUNCAN? WHAT WON'T WE BE
ABLE TO PASS OFF ON HIS DRUNKEN SERVANTS,
WHO WILL BEAR THE GUILT OF OUR GREAT CRIME?

